Daniel FERNANDEZ

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Research Interests

Primary • Business Economics • Applied microeconomics
Secondary • Labor Economics • Organizational Behavior

Education

CEMFI — Madrid, Spain
PhD in Economics and Government — Jul 2022 – Sep 2026
Master in Economics and Finance — Sep 2020 – Jun 2022

Stanford University — Palo Alto, US
Visiting Student Researcher — Jan 2025 – Mar 2025

National University of La Plata — La Plata, Argentina
Master in Economics — Jul 2015 – Sep 2019

National University of Cuyo — Mendoza, Argentina
Bachelor in Political Science and Public Administration — Apr 2009 – Sep 2016
Bachelor in Economics — Mar 2006 – Sep 2010

References

Guillermo Caruana
CEMFI
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CEMFI
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Cauê Dobbin
Georgetown University
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Placement Officers

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Tom Zohar
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Job Market Paper

Overlapping ownership in vertical relations: From fostering to tunneling, (October 2026)

The paper examines the association between ownership structures and trading partnerships among US companies. Using a novel identification strategy, I find that increasing ownership-structure similarity by one standard deviation raises the likelihood of trading partnerships—among feasible customer–supplier dyads—by roughly 10% to 19%. My findings also uncover adverse effects, as overlapping owners may privately benefit from vertical relations to the detriment of non-overlapping shareholders. Overall, baseline effects roughly quadruple when managers have incentives to transfer equity value out of the company with more diluted ownership structures.

Research Papers

Separations revisited: Do layoffs or quits drive lower separation rates in high-quality firms? (joint with Dobbin, C. & Zohar, T.), *NBER Working Paper*, 35177 (May 2026)

A well-known empirical regularity is that high-productivity firms have lower worker separation rates, but it is unclear whether this pattern reflects quits or layoffs. Using matched employer-employee data from Brazil that distinguish the reason for each separation, we show that the productivity-separation gradient is driven primarily by layoffs rather than quits. We then propose and test a mechanism in which downward wage rigidity prevents firms from adjusting wages in response to adverse shocks, causing those shocks to translate into layoffs. High-productivity firms are less exposed because their larger markdowns provide a buffer between productivity and wages. Consistent with this mechanism, we find that firms with higher markdowns have lower layoff rates, and that markets with stronger wage rigidity exhibit both higher layoff rates and a steeper productivity-layoff gradient. These findings suggest that productivity differences across firms shape not only wages, but also workers' exposure to job loss.

The wage-amenities tradeoff: Do firms offset minimum wage increases by cutting job amenities?, (April 2026)

The paper studies how firms respond to minimum wage increases. While previous studies focus on the employment-wage tradeoff, I develop a framework in which firms choose wages and job amenities, subject to binding wage floors. The model predicts that higher minimum wages compress the wage distribution but increase dispersion in job amenities. Furthermore, when firms must offer the same amenities to all employees, compensating differentials can propagate throughout the wage distribution. I test these predictions using matched employer-employee administrative data from Brazil. I recover firm-level job amenities using worker flows, and trace wage spillovers exploiting cross-state variation in the effective minimum wage. My findings support the model's predictions. The approach helps reconcile the economic intuition that firms respond to higher wage floors with recent evidence of limited employment effects.

Earlier Publications

Jobs' amenability is not enough: The role of household inputs for safe work under social distancing in Latin American cities (joint with Berniell, L.), *World Development*, 140 (2021), Article 105247

Dare to be different: Compensation schemes and strategic competition, (August 2020)

Spatial distribution of registered economic activity in Buenos Aires: a diagnosis from georeferenced social security administrative records (joint with Alves, G., Berniell, L., Castillo. V., De la Mata, D., Juncosa, C., & Rotondo, S.), *CAF Working Paper*, (December 2018, in Spanish)

Research Experience

CEMFI — Madrid, Spain
Research Assistant – Zohar, T. — Sep 2023 – Jun 2026
Research Assistant – Dobbin, C. — Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

CAF — Development Bank of Latin America — Buenos Aires, Argentina
Research Assistant – *Department of Economic Research* — Apr 2018 – Aug 2020

National University of Cuyo — Mendoza, Argentina
Research Assistant – *Department of Prospective Studies* — Feb 2012 – Aug 2014

Teaching Experience

CEMFI — Madrid, Spain
Teaching Assistant – *Summer school*
Difference-in-differences with Panel Data – Wooldridge, J. — 2025
Teaching Assistant – *Master in Economics and Finance*
Microeconomics – Caruana, G. — 2022 – 2024

National University of La Plata — La Plata, Argentina
Teaching Assistant – *Master in Economics*
Information Economics – Cont, W. — 2020

National University of Cuyo — Mendoza, Argentina
Lecturer – *School of Political and Social Sciences*
Political Analysis, Game theory & Econometrics – Caballero, C. — 2013
Teaching Assistant – *Bachelor in Political Science and Public Administration*
Introduction to Political Science – Cueto, W. — 2011

Achievements and awards

Grants and scholarships

• **Grant PRE2022-101381 (2023-2026)** by *MCIN/AEI/10.13039/501100011033 & European Social Fund Plus (ESF+)* • **Full Scholarship (2022-2023)** by *CEMFI* • **Full Scholarship (2020-2022)** by *Fundación Carolina* • **Free-tuition Scholarship (2015-2017)** by *National University of La Plata* — School of Economics

Achievements

• ***Cum laude* and *International Doctor* distinction (2026)** by *CEMFI & Universidad Internacional Menéndez Pelayo* • **Highest GPA in promotion (2016)** by *National University of Cuyo* — School of Political and Social Sciences • **Second highest GPA in promotion (2010)** by *National University of Cuyo* — School of Economics • **Special mention for early graduation (2010)** by *National University of Cuyo* — School of Economics

Awarded publications

Overlapping ownership in vertical relations

• **Second place — Best third-year paper** by *CEMFI (2023)* • **Third place — Best Master thesis in Spain** by *"Nada es Gratis" editorial team (2022)* — II Research Dissemination Contest

Conferences and seminars

• **2026** *UIB* • **2024** *SAAe EWMES* • **2023** *NBIM-Oxford* • **2018** *AAEP* • **2017** *AAEP IIESS-CONICET*

Other Information

Languages

• Spanish (native) • English (professional) • Italian (basic)

Programming languages and tools

• Python • STATA • LaTeX • GitHub